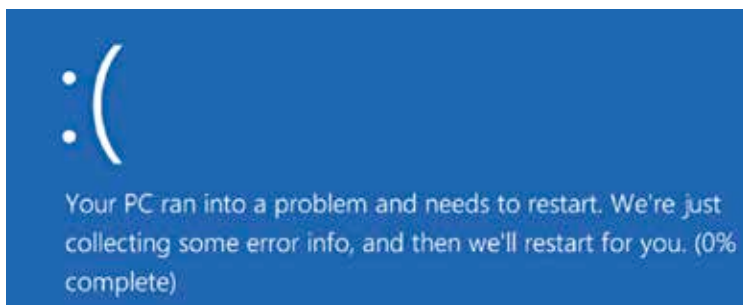


Starts slowing your system down

Your PC or laptop could actually be slowed down due to a ton of different reasons. However, this is one of the most common symptoms which occurs if anything has gone wrong with your hard disk drive. This can be a telling sign and you should immediately start thinking of a backup plan or a replacement. Suppose a system is freshly installed, or Windows is opened in Safe Mode, if in these two scenarios the system slows down, then surely the drive is gradually deteriorating.

Frequent freezing of the screen or an occurrence of the blue screen is also some of the common signs of a hard drive failure.



Collection of Bad Sectors

Bad sectors are one of the areas on the hard disk that do not maintain the integrity of data. They are really hard to identify as the operating system automatically masks them. This masked process occurs, especially when a large amount of disk is in use. Running into the bad sector is certainly a sign of the hard disk failing.

The errors which have been missed by Windows can be identified by running a manual disk check.

Follow the steps given below: *(image on next page)*

- Click Start > Computer and right-click on the disk to be checked.
- Select Properties > and then Tools tab.
- Check now.
- Scan and attempt recovery of bad sectors.

S.M.A.R.T.

Certain tools predict hard drive failure by reading the SMART (which stands for Self-Monitoring, Analysis and Reporting Technology) data. It